

**National
Association of
Baptist
Professors of
Religion**



**Association of
Ministry
Guidance
Professionals**



2026 JOINT ANNUAL CONFERENCE PROGRAM

THE CHURCH AND GLOBAL MIGRATION

May 18-20, 2026

Smoke Rise Baptist Church
Tucker, Georgia



Greetings from the BHHS Executive Director

Welcome to Tucker, Georgia, and to the 2026 joint annual conference of the Baptist History & Heritage Society! We are grateful for our continuing partnership with NABPR and AMGP. Thank you to Adam English, Jennifer Bashaw, Bill Carrell, and Ken Gore for their collaboration and collegiality. Thanks also to BHHS President Mandy McMichael for her leadership. A special word of gratitude to the staff and congregation of Smoke Rise Baptist Church for hosting us—especially associate pastor Bart McNeil and facilities manager Antowyn Smith! BHHS last met at Smoke Rise Baptist in 2018 and we are excited to be back!

We hope you will join us for our Tuesday luncheon as we honor Rev. Dr. Melody Maxwell with the 2026 W. O. Carver Distinguished Service Award and hear from Emory University professor Dr. Alison Collis Green give a talk on Baptists and the environment and how we might respond. You can find full descriptions of our luncheon and all paper presentations at www.thebhhs.org/events.

Founded in 1938, BHHS helps Baptists discover, conserve, assess and share their history while bridging the worlds of the academy and the congregation through publications, conferences, and resources for ministers, laity, academics, and students.

Since 1969, BHHS has sponsored an annual meeting to explore diverse themes and topics related to Baptist history and identity. This year's theme, the Church and Global Migration, invites us to remember that Baptist history has always been shaped by movement—missions, exile, diaspora, displacement, and the search for home. I look forward to learning together this week. Thank you for being here!

Aaron Weaver
Executive Director

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Greetings from the NABPR Executive Secretary-Treasurer

The NABPR welcomes you to the Annual May Meeting, held jointly with BHHS and AMGP! The Baugh Foundation graciously provided funds to enrich our program and your experience at the meeting, and we are deeply grateful. Special words of thanks also go to our local contact, Aaron Weaver, and to the staff and congregation of Smoke Rise Baptist Church for hosting us. NABPR President Jennifer Bashaw managed proposals and program assignments for NABPR. Jennifer Bashaw, Bill Carrell, Ken Gore, Mandy McMichael, Aaron Weaver, and myself formed the core of the May Meeting planning committee. Many other hands contributed, and they should all be thanked!

This year's theme, the Church and Global Migration, is profoundly and immediately relevant. We could not have known how relevant it would become when the May Meeting planning committee started talking about it as a possible theme two years ago. But, as our biblical studies colleagues will remind us, it is also an old and enduring theme, recalling complex histories of exile, exodus, wilderness wandering, the search for a promised land, and the treatment of foreigners and aliens in the land.

The National Association of Baptist Professors of Religion supports academic inquiry and professional development among scholars of religious studies who are connected to or interested in the Baptist tradition, and includes a quarterly peer-reviewed journal, a books series, a postdoctoral fellowship, a dissertation award, and two annual meetings.

I pray that this meeting rekindles the fires of intellectual passion and causes new ideas to ignite; I pray it renews old friendships and causes new ones to spring up. If I can be of any assistance to you during the meeting, please find me and let me know.

Adam C. English
Executive Secretary-Treasurer



Greetings from the AMGP Executive Director-Treasurer

Welcome to Atlanta, Georgia and the AMGP 2026 Annual Meeting. Our meeting again this year is held jointly with the annual meetings of our colleagues in the NABPR and BHHS. Adam English and Jennifer Bashaw (NABPR), Aaron Weaver and Mandy McMichael (BHHS), Ken Gore and I have worked closely together in planning the joint meeting. I want to thank Aaron Weaver especially for his work to coordinate with Smoke Rise Baptist Church and for logistical planning in the Atlanta area. I also want to thank the Baugh Foundation for once again providing the grant to assist with programming.

Our 2026 AMGP President, Ken Gore, has coordinated an outstanding program of presentations by our members and a special guest. Leading off the Joint Conference is a plenary interview conducted by Emily Prevost with Pablo Juarez, Pastor of FBC Kaufman en Español. Pastor Juarez's life, ministry, and writings provide an immediate and personal context for this year's theme, "The Church and Global Migration." The presentation by Steve Vernon, who has worked closely with immigration in the Rio Grande Valley, also provides needed context for this year's meeting.

Founded in 1959, AMGP is made up of Baptist theological educators responsible for guiding students through ministerial call clarification and supervised field experiences in ministry. We provide a forum for sharing information and establishing professional standards for ministry guidance. The issue of the Church and Global Migration is particularly important for AMGP, because it poses challenges for mentoring students through conflicts inherent in such politically divisive and practically difficult ministry.

Bill Carrell
Executive Director-Treasurer

Monday, May 18

8:30-11:30 am	AMGP Board Meeting	McAfee
Noon-1:00 pm	AMGP Board and Committees Lunch	McAfee
1:00-3:00 pm	AMGP Seminar/Workshop	McAfee
1:00-3:00 pm	BHHS Editorial & Board Meeting	Room 223
2:30-4:30 pm	Registration	Welcome Center
3:00-4:00 pm	NABPR Executive Committee Meeting	Room 223

4:30-6:00 pm **CONCURRENT SESSION I**

Baptist Studies I (BHHS)

Room 223

Presiding: Jerry Faught, Wayland Baptist University

Congregational History and Baptist Identity: A Review of First Baptist Church Waco: A Legacy of Education, Missions, and Service

Glenn Jonas, Campbell University
Doug Weaver, Baylor University
William L. Pitts, Baylor University

A President in Church: Getting Jimmy Carter Out of the Archives

Christi Harlan, Christi Harlan Media LLC

Baptist Studies II (BHHS)

Room 307

Presiding: Laura Levens, BSK Theological Seminary

Finding a Home Among Baptists: 50 Years of the Welcoming and Affirming Movement

C. Delane Tew, Samford University

Harvey Springer: Baptist Fascist?

Christopher Price, New River Community and Technical College

Rhetorical Fictions and the Witch Hunt of Women in Ministry: A Narrative Criticism of Southern Baptist Convention Discourse (1984–2023)

Meg Rooney, University of Georgia

Presiding: Jennifer Garcia Bashaw, Campbell University

Reading Revelation 12 with Black Mothers: Calling the Church to Hospitality

Kierra Prather, McAfee School of Theology at Mercer University

Silence Speaks at Midnight: Midnight as Borderland

Rochelle Samuel, McAfee School of Theology at Mercer University

Response: Angela Parker

McAfee School of Theology at Mercer University

6:00-7:00 pm

JOINT BANQUET

Fellowship Hall

7:00-8:00 pm

PLENARY SESSION I

Fellowship Hall

Conversation on the Church and Global Migration

Rev. Dr. Pablo Juarez reflects on immigration as a pastoral and congregational reality, not simply a political issue, in a conversation hosted by Dr. Emily Prevost. Drawing on his own story and his ministry at First Baptist Church en Español in Kaufman, Texas, Rev. Juarez speaks about the fear, instability and disruption many immigrant families are facing and the ways those pressures shape the life of a congregation. This opening plenary session considers how churches respond when detention, deportation and family separation are no longer distant concerns but present realities in the communities they serve.

Pablo Juarez is pastor of First Baptist Church en Español in Kaufman, Texas. Originally from Nicaragua, he has served as a church planter, pastor and educator and holds degrees from Campbell University and Dallas Baptist University.

Emily Prevost is a professor at the University of Mary Hardin-Baylor in Belton, Texas.

Tuesday, May 19

8:30-10:15 am

CONCURRENT SESSION II

Baptist Studies III (BHHS)

Room 309

Presiding: Andrew Smith, Carson-Newman University

Stubborn, Tenacious and Sensitive: Annie Armstrong and Controversies

Melody Maxwell, Acadia Divinity College

The Scandal, Strength and Spirituality of a Female Missionary

Reid S. Trulson, American Baptist International Ministries

The Liturgical Agency of Female Believers: Expanding Women's Access to Religious Authority

Meg Rooney, University of Georgia

Baptist Studies IV (BHHS)

Children's Suite (3rd Floor)

Presiding: John Inscore Essick, BSK Theological Seminary

Willie Dawson: The Power of Speech

Bill Pitts, Baylor University

Crossing Boundaries of Race and Geography: The Rev. J. C. Herrin in the Southern Baptist and American Baptist Denominations

Deborah Bingham Van Broekhoven, American Baptist Historical Society

Reinterpreting the Baptist Mission: Garland A. Hendricks and Rural Church Reform, 1940-1953

Joshua S. Pruitt, Southeastern Baptist Theological Seminary

Baptist Studies V (BHHS)

Room 223

Presiding: Mel Hawkins, Carson-Newman University

Fidelity to God's Word: Christian Nationalism and Inerrancy in the Southern Baptist Convention

Benjamin Potter, International Baptist Theological Seminary

Messing with Texas: The Baptist Joint Committee's Legislative Advocacy in the Lone Star State
Jerry Faught, Wayland Baptist University

Diaspora, Distance and Discipleship: How Black Baptists Navigate Christian Nationalism's Moral Geography
Michaela Calahan, Southern Methodist University

Biblical Interpretation II (NABPR)

Room 307

Presiding: Scott Shauf, Gardner-Webb University

Dad Jokes and Lament in Micah 1
Anna Sieges Beal, Gardner-Webb University

'You Shall Love the Stranger': Old Testament Ethics of the Alien and Contemporary Immigration Policy
Donald Raney, Wayland Baptist University

Whom Do We Trust: The Failure of Christian Formation and the Rise of Conspiracy Theories
Seth Heringer, Toccoa Falls College

Everyone Deserves to Read: Using Critical Exegesis Practice and Pedagogical Alliance to Empower Interpreters of Scripture
Laura Levens, BSK Theological Seminary

Christian Ethics I (NABPR)

Room 306

Presiding: Jacob Cook, Eastern Mennonite University

A Matrixial Psychoanalytic Case Study for Addressing Christian Nationalism
Matthew S. Beal, Boston University

Fear of Vulnerability and the Production of Fascist Subjectivity
Ryan Newson, Campbell University

Moral Minority, Immoral Majority: Lessons from the Rise and Fall of Evangelical Purity Culture to Disrupt White Christian Nationalism Now
Kathryn House, Meadville Lombard Theological School

Presiding: Glenn Jonas, Campbell University

The Church in Conflict: Karl Barth, Liberation Theology, and the Struggle for Belonging

Kyle Barton, Baylor University

A Black Comparative Religious Study of Christianity and Islam

Brandon Richmond, Gardner-Webb University

'Tell the Truth to Shame the Devil': Uvee Ross and the Founding of the Progressive National Baptist Convention, Inc.

Pamela A. Smoot, Southern Illinois University

Ministry Studies I (AMGP)

Room 310

Presiding: Ken Gore, Dallas Baptist University

The Role of Short-Term Missions in Ministry Training

Dennis Horton, Baylor University

Vocational Exploration in a Globally Connected World

Emily Prevost, University of Mary Hardin-Baylor

Analyzing Theological Dynamic in Exegesis

Mike Baird, Grand Canyon University

10:30-Noon

PLENARY SESSION II

Sanctuary

Fresh Anointings in Times of Tribulation: Learning from the Theologies of Vulnerable Migrant Communities

Dr. Jonathan Calvillo examines how discussions of migration and religion often cast immigrants as objects to be studied and acted upon rather than as subjects within stories they are co-creating; the current political climate, with immigrants facing heavy surveillance and enforcement, adds to this tendency.

The agency of migrants is further minimized when narratives of migrant faith emphasize the influence of North American missions upon migrants' homelands and the activities of U.S.-based religious institutions within migrant communities. Nevertheless, especially in the current

moment, it is important to recognize that theology is a key site of agency for immigrants. In the face of current adversity, immigrants are responding through faith.

Drawing on his research, Calvillo highlights some of the lived theologies observed among church leaders and congregants from communities living on the edge. In keeping with his previous work, he focuses especially on Latino immigrant communities. The cases considered are of Protestant background, with particular attention to lived and expressed theologies emerging from places such as Atlanta, Minneapolis and Los Angeles.

Jonathan Calvillo is Associate Professor of Latinx Communities at Candler School of Theology at Emory University. His work examines how distinct Latinx populations build communities of belonging through faith and creativity, often in the face of systemic exclusion.

Noon-1:45 pm **BUSINESS MEETINGS/LUNCHEONS**

AMGP Lunch and Business Meeting
BHHS Awards Luncheon and Business Meeting
NABPR Lunch and Business Meeting

Children's Suite (3rd Floor)
Room 223
Fellowship Hall

2:00-3:45 pm **CONCURRENT SESSION III**

Baptist Studies VI (BHHS)

Room 310

Presiding: Doug Weaver, Baylor University

A Mere Kentuckian: Celebrating the Life and Published Works of Dr. Keith Harper

Andrew Smith, Carson-Newman University

Baptists and World War II: Telling the Stories

Presentation: *To the Ends of the Earth: Southern Baptist Missions in the Balkans, 1938-1945, and Other WWII Research Opportunities at the Southern Baptist Historical Library & Archives*

Taffey Hall, Southern Baptist Historical
Library and Archives

Presentation: *The Effect of WWII in Shaping God's Call and Missions Service: Japanese-Americans Reiji and Asano Hoshizaki, and Other WWII Research Opportunities at Baylor University*

Kathy Hillman, Baylor University

Baptist Studies VII (BHHS)

Room 309

Presiding: Meg Rooney, University of Georgia

Scattered Yet Gathered: Baptist Identity and the Theology of Diaspora

R. Connor Evans, New Orleans Baptist Theological Seminary

Manichean Fire: Gilbert Tennent, James Davenport and the Roots of Separate Baptist Dualism

Daniel Alan Long, Indiana University

The Bible, Humor and Being a Baptist

William E. Ellis, Eastern Kentucky University

Baptist Studies VIII (BHHS)

Room 306

Presiding: Stuart Sprague, Anderson University

J. B. Hartwell and the Global Missionary Movement

John E. Shaffett, Brewton-Parker Christian University

Here We Have No Lasting City: Soviet Evangelical-Baptist Immigration to the United States in the Late 1980s

Sarah MacKenzie, University of Alabama in Huntsville

Towards Filipinization of the Southern Baptists in the Philippines: Surveyed and Considered

John Paul Arceno, Southwestern Baptist
Theological Seminary

Biblical Interpretation and Pedagogy: Joint Session of NABPR/AMGP

Room 223

Teaching Biblical Interpretation with Serving Up Scripture

Introduction: Jennifer Garcia Bashaw, Campbell University

Panelists:

Anna Sieges Beal, Gardner-Webb University
Seth Heringer, Toccoa Falls College
Susan Benton, Baylor University

Presiding: TBA

Ministry, Marriage, and Me: Ordained Canadian Baptist Women on Marital Status and Family Responsibilities, 1976-2024

Melody Maxwell, Acadia Divinity College

The Once and Future Country Church: Mark Rich and Rural Baptist Congregations

John Inscore Essick, BSK Theological Seminary

'Quite the Bloomin' Allegation': Harold Bloom's 1992 Charge of the Exemplification of Neo-Gnosticism in the Southern Baptist Convention

Wyman Lewis Richardson, Central Baptist Church in North Little Rock, Arkansas

John D. Freeman and the Mercer Heresy Trials

Bryan J. Whitfield, Mercer University

Early Christian Theology and the New Testament (NABPR)

Room 307

Presiding: Adam English, Campbell University

Unchanging Gospel Message, Changing Context: Contextualization Strategies in Lukan Paul, Irenaeus, and Athanasius

Joy Axelsson, Gardner-Webb University

Why Christus Victor?: Jewish Influences on Early Christian Atonement

Eric Wickman, University of Mary Hardin-Baylor

Sacrifice in Early Christian Theology and Practice

Scott Shauf, Gardner-Webb University

Wednesday, May 20

8:30-10:15 am

CONCURRENT SESSION IV

The Baptist World Alliance – Reading History through Biography

Melody Maxwell, Acadia Divinity College

Doug Weaver, Baylor University

Merrill Hawkins, Carson-Newman University

Glenn Jonas, Campbell University

C. Delane Tew, Samford University

Presiding: Ossie X. McKinney, Cooperative Baptist Fellowship

Making a Baptist College a Safe Space from Which to Wage Culture War: Louisiana College/Christian University, 2007–2023

Christopher Schelin, Starr King School for the Ministry

Transformed by Fellowship: Japanese Americans and Antiracism in Northern Baptist Home Missions

Jenny Manasco, American Baptist Historical Society

Brice Bongiovanni, American Baptist Historical Society

James Ralph Noonkester: A Promoter of World Missions, Pioneer Educator and Champion of Racial Justice

Charles Dollar, History Author and Researcher

Presiding: Ryan Newson, Campbell University

Unashamedly Christian, Unashamedly Modern: Baptist Theology for American Democratic Society

Michael Laminack, University of Mary Hardin-Baylor

Personal Agency, Liberative Community, and the Reorientation of Christian Practice

Jacob Cook, Eastern Mennonite University

The Muscle and the Margin: How Baptist Masculinity Constructs the 'Strong' National Body Against Migrant Vulnerability

Michaela Calahan, Southern Methodist University

Presiding: Jack Bodenhamer, Truett Seminary, Baylor University

Immigration and the Church: A Survey of Work in the Rio Grande Valley

Steve Vernon, University of Mary Hardin-Baylor

The Pedagogy of Leadership for Undergraduate Students: Teaching the How, When, and Why of this Vital Ministerial Competency

Jane Wilson, Baylor University

Lisa Seeley, East Texas Baptist University

Group Discussion: Ministry Guidance in Light of the Plenary Sessions

Presiding: Scott Ryan, Claflin University

Teaching Biblical Greek with Documentary Papyri

Joel Weaver, Truett Seminary, Baylor University

A Colorful Classroom: A Pedagogical Case Study for Integrating Marginalized Voices in Baptist Homiletics Curricula

Jesse Nelson, Meachum School of Theology

Teaching Outside the Box: Exploring Neurodiversity

Paula Fontana Qualls, Gardner-Webb University

Everything Teaches: Church Spaces as Places of Belonging for Children and Families

Sarah Boberg, Campbell University Divinity School

Theology and the Church Panel: “Liberating Our Democracy: Black and Indigenous Traditions, Resistance, and the Moral Imagination” (NABPR)

Religion and Resistance in Black Communities: ‘We Are Here, and We Matter’

Lawrence E. Claiborne, United Lutheran Seminary

A Theology for Wholeness Toward a Requiem for Du Bois, Double Consciousness

James Jones, Jr., United Lutheran Seminary

Fractured Legacies: African and Native American Relations, Resistance, and the Limits of Colonial Christianity

David Hoxter, United Lutheran Seminary

The Cross, Credibility, and the Cry of the Oppressed

Gabriella Harris, United Lutheran Seminary

Response: Black and Indigenous Influences and Resources for Democratizing Knowledge

Adam DJ Brett, United Lutheran Seminary

10:30-Noon

PLENARY SESSION III

Sanctuary

The Bible in the Baptist Tradition

In *The Bible in the Baptist Tradition*, Doug Weaver and Mikeal C. Parsons explore how Baptists have read, interpreted and argued about the Bible across four centuries of history. Their study examines how Baptists have engaged the Bible as a source of authority, tracing themes such as freedom of conscience, believer’s baptism, local church independence, and the interplay of personal and communal experience, the Bible and the Spirit. The book also considers how Baptists have wrestled with the challenges of modern biblical scholarship and debates involving race, gender and sexuality.

This panel brings the authors into conversation with Baptist scholars to reflect on how Baptists have engaged the Bible throughout their history and how those patterns continue to shape preaching, teaching and congregational life today.

Mikeal Parsons is University Distinguished Professor and Professor of Religion at Baylor University, specializing in the New Testament, particularly Luke–Acts.

Doug Weaver is the Driskell Professor of Historical Studies and Chair of the Department of Religion at Baylor University, where he teaches and researches Baptist history and Pentecostalism.

Elizabeth “Ebby” Arnold serves as Scholar-in-Residence for The Candler Foundry at Emory University’s Candler School of Theology, where she teaches New Testament and is creator of an online certificate program for community- and church-based theological education.

Kim Bodenhamer is a biblical scholar and Senior Academic Writing Consultant at Baylor University whose work focuses on the Hebrew Bible and theological education.

Marcus Jerkins is Senior Pastor of New Pilgrim Baptist Church in Birmingham, Alabama, and a pastor, scholar and author whose work engages theology, preaching and Black Baptist life.

Sandy Martin is Professor of Religion at the University of Georgia and a historian of American religion whose work focuses on African American religious history and Baptist traditions.

